A FESTIVAL CELEBRATING THE LAND

Chennai Sangamam – Namma Ooru Thiruvizha is a four-day cultural festival being held from January 14 across 16 venues in Chennai. It promises to be an event to remember.

An annual festival which acts as a showcase of local folk and classical performance traditions as well as art, Chennai Sangamam – Namma Ooru Thiruvizha is back on a grand scale this year.

Last year, owing to COVID, the festival was held as a one-day celebration, with over 400 performers from around Tamil Nadu displaying different traditional styles of art and culture. The celebration was held at the Island Grounds, Chennai, on March 21st, 2022 and attracted thousands of spectators.

Organised jointly by the Department of Tourism and the Department of Arts and Culture, Tamil Nadu, the Namma Ooru Thiruvizha festival is a way to support local traditional artists who faced pandemic-induced unemployment during COVID due to a shortage of opportunities to perform.

This year the festival is back in a much bigger format. Chief Minister M.K. Stalin will launch the festival at a grand cultural programme at Island Grounds in Chennai on January 13. From January 14 to 17, a whopping 700 artistes from across the state as well as the country will perform at 16 venues across the city. There is no entrance fee for the performances which will be held in a variety of venues including beaches, parks and playgrounds. The locations include Elliot's Beach in Besant Nagar, Corporation Ground in Kolathur, Tennis Ground in Nungambakkam, Nageswara Rao Park in Mylapore, and so on.

The cultural programmes will include both folk and classical performances. Youth bands are also slated to enthral the attendees. The artistes will perform in 30-minute slots from 6pm to 9pm daily at the 16 locations.

A major highlight of the festival will be the 108 food stalls which will offer visitors an opportunity to sample the traditional foods of the state. Iruttu Kadai Halwa, Kadala Mittai and Srivilliputhur Palkova are just some of the delicacies that will be available. Besides that, visitors can see traditional games being played. A book fair, literary festival and art exhibitions are also planned as part of the grand celebrations.

Chennai Sangamam – Namma Ooru Thiruvizha coincides with Pongal and promises to add a new dimension to the traditional harvest festival. Later, the Sangamam will be held in different locations across Tamil Nadu throughout 2023, including Coimbatore, Tiruchy, Madurai and so on.

A laudable initiative conceived to support and promote the traditional art and folk artists of Tamil Nadu, Namma Ooru Thiruvizha is a great way to celebrate the best the state has to offer in terms of art and culture.















